

A fact should **lead somewhere.**

A civic-information workspace for African communities. Find a fact, trace its source, connect it to the office that holds the next step — and leave with a packet you can send, print, or carry on a USB stick.

Information without action is just noise.

- Fragmented across offices, formats and languages
- Out of date, with no way to tell from what's current
- Hard to verify — source, date and limits all unstated
- Locked behind systems that are hard to navigate

13

COUNTRIES

14

SEEDED TRAILS

5

DATA LAYERS

257K

DATA POINTS

This is not a news feed. It is a workspace.

1. Find a fact

Browse by track, country or layer. Every record names its source, when it was last checked, and what it does not tell you.

2. Follow the trail

Each record names a holder, a witness and the exact question to ask. A next step, not just a fact.

3. Leave with a packet

Send, print, broadcast or carry. Four formats for four real channels. The packet is the product.

Every record belongs to one.

Transparency & Accountability

Turn a published budget, tender, audit finding or service standard into a written question with a named recipient and a response date.

Stability & Social Cohesion

Route everyday friction — a broken water point, a land question, a shared-resource dispute — to the body that can resolve it, before it escalates.

Safety, Reporting & Protection

Write a report that carries no identifiers, get a reference, and reach a real pathway: oversight body, legal aid, or survivor support.

14 seeded records, 13 countries.

Each record carries:

- Source name, type, URL, update cadence
- Last-checked date (not assumed current)
- Explicit limitations (required field)
- Separate confidence & importance scores
- Named holder + witness
- The exact question to ask

EXAMPLE: MAKUENI, KENYA

Holder: District Water Office

Witness: County WASH Coordinator

Ask: "Where is the published allocation for this water point, and how can residents submit feedback?"

Source: Wasreb · checked 2026-09-21 · Unverified — illustrative

Residents raise what's not working.

Borehole at Kathiani market has been dry three weeks

Kathiani, Kenya · 7 votes · **Community-verified**

Tender award for the feeder road not published

Kumasi, Ghana · 2 votes · **Open**

GRADUATION

- ① Resident raises an issue with no votes
- ② At 3 votes → community-verified
- ③ At 5 votes → promoted to official trail with holder + date

Votes are local. Without a relay, nobody else sees them. Every issue card says so.

5 geospatial layers, 257,153 features.

Every data-layer point is listed in the Trails tab and trackable as a trail.

LAYER	SOURCE	RECORDS	STATUS
♥ Health	HOT OSM via HDX	42,999	✓ Live
🎓 Education	HOT OSM via HDX	209,267	✓ Capped at 4K
💧 Water	HOT OSM via HDX	8,741	✓ Live
⚡ Power	World Bank GPPP	228	✓ Live
🏪 Markets	ETH market centers	2,060	✓ Live
🗺 Grid lines	Africa Infra Grid	0	⚠ Corrupted

Everything else is scaffolding for **the thing the user leaves with.**

Packet

The full brief with a next-step sequence. Exports as PDF.

WhatsApp

Short, forwardable, keeps the source and the check date.

SMS

One line for a basic phone. Source + question intact.

Radio / Meeting

A script to read out, with a warning not to name individuals. For community meetings, radio call-ins, and print-and-carry.

It runs from a USB stick.

No server, no install, no network.

Two builds, genuinely different

Single-file (0.65 MB)

Double-click trail-offline.html. Boots because nothing is requested at runtime.

Folder (served)

Adds facility layers plus service-worker offline cache. Served only.

30+ TESTS

- Offline cold-start over file://
- Persistent local storage
- Render correctness (markers, labels, icons)
- Layer panel toggle → marker count
- All tabs functional
- No console errors

Five rules, never broken.

① A source is never shown as verified unless it is. 0 of 14 seeded records are independently checked — stated in the UI.

② "Unchecked" is distinct from "stale". Freshness is computed against each source's own cadence.

③ Limitations are a required field. Every record states what it does not tell you.

④ Confidence and importance are separate. How much it matters vs how much it can be trusted.

⑤ A gap never becomes a claim. Unknown = "unknown". No URL = "No URL".

React, Vite, no backend.

Stack

- React 18 + Vite
- D3-geo (orthographic + Mercator)
- SVG markers with <use> icon symbols
- Lucide icons
- Local storage (no backend)
- Service worker (offline cache)

Build pipeline

- Python ingest → GeoJSON simplification
- Vite build → dist/
- Portable bundler → single-file HTML
- Service worker generator
- Playwright verification (30+ harnesses)

Stated so nobody has to discover it.

No server

Votes and issues cannot sync between devices.

No live data

Snapshot dated 21 Sep 2026. Nothing polls.

No encryption

Local storage is readable by anyone with device access.

No referral DB

Report routes by category, not to a verified org list.

Share buttons

Need a connection (hand text to an app).

Anonymity

No state-run mechanism confirmed to accept anonymous submissions.

TRAIL AFRICA

A fact should lead somewhere.

Trusted civic information, across Africa.

13 countries. 14 trails. 5 data layers. 257K features. Zero server. Runs from a USB stick. Leaves with a packet you can send.

github.com/Prodigeezyxx/trail · OSF × Andela · Sep 2026